

Side

Side gets you started.

Set aside. Be beside. Step inside. By your side.

A desktop app and a Chrome extension for people who can't stop at night and can't start in the morning.

The problem

Some nights you can't stop. Most mornings you can't start.

They are the same problem. You keep going tonight because you're not sure the flow will come back tomorrow, and tomorrow the unfinished pile makes it harder to begin.

> **"Every plan I didn't follow was the planner mocking me."**
>
> Calm Diligence (Substack), on planners and ADHD

> **"Reviewing things every 10 mins destroys my attention span."**
>
> Hacker News comment on working with AI coding agents

Backlog shame came up in five separate places we read, and so did "TODO bankruptcy". These show that the problem exists, not how common it is.

The insight

You don't need a better plan. You need a `select 1`.

Our founder's trick: when work won't start, open the tool and run `select 1`. One result appears on screen, and a few minutes later you are working. Side prepares that first step for you, and every step it offers passes four checks.

1 No judgment

Nothing to decide. It only opens what you left.

2 Can't fail

A real page that exists, never a site you excluded.

3 In the real tool

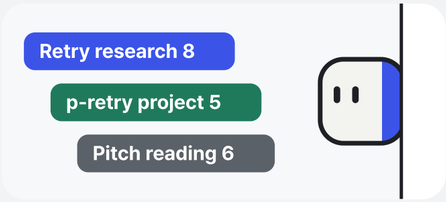
Your doc, your repo. Not a to-do list about them.

4 Instant result

You see it right away, at the paragraph where you stopped.

How it works

Four beats, one small character at the edge of your screen.



Set Aside

Night. You decide to stop.

Your real tabs fold into named Chrome groups with one confirm. One optional line: *What are you most curious about tomorrow?* Undo brings everything back.

We count: tabs set aside, lines left for tomorrow

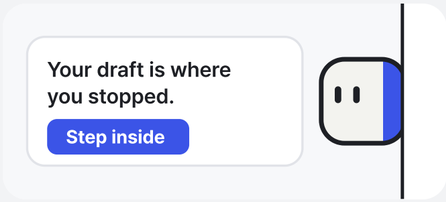


Be Beside

Flow, rest, three days away.

sidy waits at the screen edge, eyes only. No nagging, no backlog. "One more hour?" is never blocked: you get one fact and one check-in at a time you choose.

We count: times sidy spoke (fewer is better)

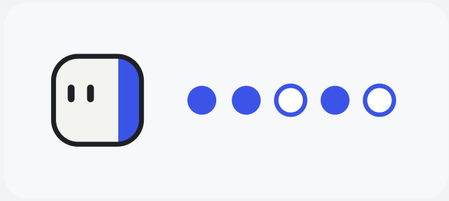


Step Inside

The next day, you drift back.

One bubble, one step: the page you stopped on opens at the paragraph, marked "You stopped here". Nothing opens until you choose.

We count: steps clicked, seconds to work



By your side

Days and weeks.

Side keeps a record of which steps got you going and whether you kept at it ten minutes later. The next step learns from it.

We count: still working 10 min after a step

Demo

90 seconds, on the real app with real Chrome tabs.

A screen recording with no mockups and no motion graphics. The night and the next day come from Side's demo clock, which moves only Side's own clock.

Problem	Set Aside	Be Beside	Step Inside	By your side
0–10 s	10–35 s	35–50 s	50–70 s	70–90 s

Set Aside

"One more hour", then "Done". 20+ real tabs fold into named groups. One line for tomorrow.

Be Beside

The app is quit and relaunched the next evening. sidy sits at the edge and says nothing.

Step Inside

While a video plays, one bubble appears. Click it, and last night's paragraph opens.

By your side

Main shows the real counts from that use, and the next step.

What Side won't do

Trust is the product.

Never

- Finish your work for you
- Shut things off or block you when time's up
- Show backlogs or failure-streak counts
- Encourage all-nighters
- Promise what sleep will do for you
- Counsel your mood or diagnose you
- Compare you with other people
- Let an employer watch employees
- Capture your screen

Your data

- Addresses and page text never leave your computer.
- Tab titles go to Claude only to name your groups. One switch turns it off.
- Sites you exclude are never read, saved or sent.
- **What Side saw** lists every tab Side read, skipped and sent.

Not in this build

Login · uploading tab contents · conversational planning · calendar and mail integration · payment · learning your type · Windows and mobile · a Korean interface

Why not a planner, a chatbot, or a tab manager

They help you decide. Side helps you start.

What people use	What it does	Side's difference (hypothesis)
Sunsama $17–22 a month	Decides what to do today: daily planning, Autoplan, break reminders	**Shortens the distance to starting, follows what you were already doing, and nothing piles up after days off**
Chatbots free to paid	Plan and break down work when you ask	**You have to open a chatbot, and when you're avoiding work you don't. sidy is already on screen.**
Tab managers Toby, Workona	Save and organize tabs	**Tabs are only the raw material for the next step**
Desktop pets Comnyang, $3.90 once	Live on screen and react to typing and AI tools	**Side doesn't react. It prepares the step that gets you back in.**

Free habits such as turning the phone off or working next to someone help some people, but someone avoiding work can't prepare their own first step. Sources: public product pages and reviews, read on Nov 8, 2026.

Traction, measured live

Counted by Side itself, on our own machine.

Live numbers come from our own use of Side during the event. They appear here from Side's local records, with the sample size, once there are records to count. No numbers are estimated or made up.

Waitlist sign-ups so far: 0.

n = 1 user (our team), during the event. A small sample: it shows the loop works end to end, not that it scales.

side-waitlist.vercel.app

Join the waitlist

Business model

Free builds the habit. Pro pays for what Side prepares.

	Free	Pro (subscription)
For	Anyone trying Side	People who stop and restart every day
Includes	sidy · Set Aside with Undo · one step that opens where you stopped · excluded sites · What Side saw · group names from Claude	Claude prepares your step and today's line · reopens your recent files where you were · results prepared in advance · By your side learning · connected tools
Price	Free	**To be tested**, somewhere between a one-time desktop pet ($3.90) and a planner ($17–22 a month)
Unit cost	LLM cost per active user per month = requests a day × tokens per request × model price × 30. Example: **about $1.00**, assuming 3 requests a day, 1,460 input and 264 output tokens per request (an earlier prototype's measured average, n = 3), and Claude Opus 5.5 list prices of $4 / $20 per million tokens. This is a hypothesis to be measured in the beta.	
Why they stay	Productivity apps have a 23% median first-year renewal rate (RevenueCat), tied for lowest of any category. Side's answer: nothing piles up while you're away, so coming back is easy. And every step you take teaches the next one, which is hard to leave behind.	

Beta metrics: share of prepared steps clicked · share still working 10 minutes after clicking · 4-week retention · Free to Pro conversion.

Roadmap: from a hackathon build to a subscription

Toward a personal agent: a focus buddy while you work, a lifestyle consultant around it.

This build is its first slice: stopping and starting again. Chrome is the first connected tool. Each step sends only what that feature needs.

Now

Hackathon build

- Desktop app + Chrome extension
- All four beats run on real tabs
- Install from the README alone
- Waitlist open, step-by-step public commits

First sign-ups from the QR

Beta

Invites from the waitlist

- Signed desktop app, Chrome Web Store
- Login
- Test whether a step someone else prepared still works, with 5 people first
- Pricing test, no charge

4-week retention · willingness to pay

Pro

The subscription

- Steps Claude prepares, results prepared in advance
- Conversational planning and schedule adjustment
- Learning your type: By your side
- Voice input, detailed stats
- Make sidy yours: gentle rewards, never streak shame

Payment and subscription start

Everywhere

More tools, more people

- Connected tools: calendar, mail, IDE, Claude Code, Microsoft Office, DBMS, desktop music and video apps
- Windows and mobile
- More languages, Korean first

More people, higher tiers

Ask

Join the beta.

Scan to join the waitlist: one email field, nothing else. In the beta we will measure two numbers.

Steps clicked

How many of the steps sidy prepares people actually click.

Still working

How many keep going 10 minutes after clicking.

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